

STILL IN MOTION

A Parkinson's Handwriting & Movement Workbook

A practical, adult-centered workbook for hands, writing, coordination, and everyday function.

PREPARE • MOVE • WRITE • USE

Purposeful practice, not perfection. Use the pages at a comfortable pace and adapt activities to your abilities.

DESIGNED FOR ADULTS LIVING WITH PARKINSON'S DISEASE

A calm place to keep practicing the movements that matter in ordinary life.

Dedication

To Fred, Bill, Bob, and Jack

This book is dedicated to the Vietnam veterans I have had the privilege of working with who live with Parkinson's disease.

To **Fred, Bill, and Bob**—thank you for allowing me to work alongside you, learn from you, and witness the determination you bring to each day. Your strength, perseverance, and willingness to keep moving forward have left an impression on me that I will carry with me.

And especially to **Jack**.

Jack, you are the reason this book came to life.

Working with you showed me that the small things matter. Every movement, every attempt, every bit of progress, and every day of continuing to try has meaning. Your determination inspired me to create something practical that could help people maintain their movement, coordination, and independence while giving them something positive to work toward each day.

This book is a reflection of what I have learned from all of you.

It is written with respect for the challenges you face, admiration for the strength you continue to show, and hope that these exercises can become one small part of helping others keep moving forward.

To Fred, Bill, Bob, and especially Jack—thank you.

Your perseverance inspired these pages.

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A Note to Caregivers

Helping Make Movement Part of the Day

Caring for someone living with Parkinson's disease often means helping with many different parts of daily life. Among those responsibilities, it can be easy for structured movement and hand exercises to become something that gets pushed aside.

This workbook was created to help make practice **simple, purposeful, and easy to incorporate into an everyday routine.**

The exercises are designed around movement, coordination, hand use, finger control, direction changes, and writing practice. Rather than treating these activities as another large task on an already busy schedule, the goal is to create a short period of focused practice that can become a familiar part of the day.

How to Use This Workbook

A simple **10-minute daily routine** can be enough to establish consistency.

Choose a time of day when the individual is generally comfortable, alert, and able to participate. A consistent time can make the exercises easier to remember and turn them into a routine rather than something that has to be repeatedly introduced.

A typical session can follow this progression:

1. Get Comfortable

Have the individual seated comfortably at a stable surface with the workbook positioned where it is easy to see and reach.

Make sure there is adequate lighting and that unnecessary distractions are minimized.

2. Begin With the Movement Exercises

Start with the movement and hand warm-up activities before moving into the writing exercises. Encourage deliberate, controlled movements rather than rushing through the page.

3. Progress Into the Letter Exercises

Once the hands and fingers have been warmed up, move into the letter activities.

The workbook gradually progresses from larger movements toward more controlled writing. Encourage the individual to focus on **accuracy and purposeful movement rather than speed.**

4. Encourage Both Hands

When an exercise calls for both hands, encourage participation with both sides as instructed. If one hand is more difficult to use, patience is especially important. Allow additional time rather than immediately completing the activity for the individual.

5. Keep Encouragement Positive

The goal is participation and consistent practice—not perfection. Praise effort, attention, persistence, and improvement.

A simple:

“That was better than yesterday.” or

“Take your time—you've got it” can make practice

feel encouraging rather than frustrating.

Make It Part of Everyday Life

Consider attaching the workbook to an activity that already happens every day. For example:

After breakfast, workbook practice

After morning hygiene workbook practice

Before a favorite afternoon activity, workbook practice

A familiar routine can make it easier to remember and maintain. Consistency is more important than completing a large amount of work at once.

Let the Individual Take the Lead

Whenever possible, allow the individual to complete the exercises independently. The caregiver's role is to **support, encourage, and assist when needed**, rather than taking over the activity.

Give the individual time to attempt a movement or exercise before aiding. Preserving opportunities for active participation can make the practice more meaningful and can help maintain a sense of independence and accomplishment.

Adjust to the Individual

Every person with Parkinson's disease is different.

Some days may be easier than others. Fatigue, stiffness, medication timing, mood, and other factors can affect participation.

If an activity becomes excessively difficult or frustrating, take a break and return to it later.

The workbook should be used as a **flexible practice tool**, not a test.

There is no need to rush through the pages.

Progress at a comfortable pace and repeat activities when additional practice is helpful.

Most Importantly

Make the experience positive.

This is not about filling out pages.

It is about creating a small, consistent opportunity each day to **move, practice, participate, and keep working toward independence.**

Your encouragement can make a meaningful difference.

Thank you for being part of that process.

Important Note

This workbook is intended as a general activity and practice resource and is not a substitute for individualized medical care, physical therapy, occupational therapy, or other professional guidance. Caregivers should follow the recommendations of the individual's healthcare and therapy team and discontinue an activity if it causes pain, significant discomfort, dizziness, unusual shortness of breath, or other concerning symptoms.

A note to the reader

The things you can still do matter. Writing your name, making a grocery list, leaving a note, filling out a form, or simply putting pen to paper can be ordinary parts of life—and ordinary things are worth practicing.

THE AIM

Build a repeatable practice habit around comfortable movement, writing size, control, and everyday use. This book is designed to be revisited, not completed once.

WHAT THIS BOOK EMPHASIZES

Prepare

Wake up the hands and create a calm transition into writing.

Move

Practice lines, curves, loops, and larger movements before letters.

Write

Progress through uppercase and lowercase A-M with generous writing space.

Use

Apply the same skills to words, numbers, lists, notes, and daily tasks.

Some days will feel easier than others. You do not have to force a difficult day into a good one. Adjust the activity, pause when needed, and return when you are comfortable.

How this workbook works

01 PREPARE

Spend a few minutes getting hands ready.

02 MOVE

Practice controlled movement before letters.

03 WRITE

Work through uppercase and lowercase A-M.

04 USE

Connect writing to everyday tasks.

05 REPEAT

Return to pages that feel useful.

A NOTE ABOUT PROGRESS

Your handwriting may look different from one day to the next. Use the workbook to notice what feels comfortable and intentional—not to grade yourself.

Your practice philosophy

COMFORT FIRST

Practice should feel purposeful, not punishing. Do not push through pain.

ATTENTION MATTERS

Slow down enough to notice the movement you are making. You are practicing control, not racing the page.

SIZE CAN BE PRACTICED

When a page asks for a larger movement, aim for a large, comfortable movement. Bigger does not mean strained.

REPEAT WHAT HELPS

You are allowed to revisit a page. A workbook becomes more useful when it fits into real life.

GOOD DAYS AND DIFFICULT DAYS COUNT

Adjust the challenge to how your hands feel today.

THE STANDARD

A successful page is not a perfect page. It is a page you participated in.

Why handwriting practice?

Handwriting is a meaningful everyday activity, and Parkinson's disease can affect handwriting in several ways, including smaller writing and changes in speed, force, fluency, and consistency.

WHAT THE EVIDENCE SAYS

A 2021 systematic review found strong strength of evidence for occupational therapy-related interventions addressing handwriting in people with Parkinson's disease. Later reviews describe handwriting-specific training as promising, while also noting that studies remain limited and heterogeneous.

This workbook uses that evidence as context—not as a promise. The goal is to turn evidence-informed ideas into practical, purposeful handwriting and movement practice.

WHAT THE RESEARCH SUPPORTS

- Meaningful, task-related handwriting practice can be useful.
- Visual targets and writing-size cues have been studied in Parkinson's disease.
- Upper-limb exercise and task-related training can support hand dexterity.
- Individualization matters: comfort, goals, symptoms, and function differ by person.

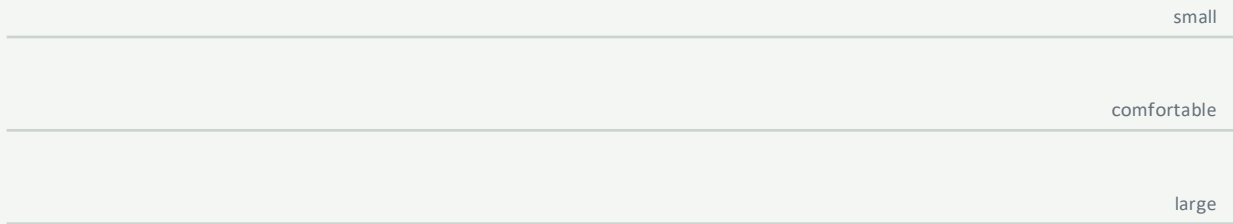
KEEP THE CLAIMS HONEST

Research supports practice as a meaningful rehabilitation strategy. It does not mean a workbook can treat, reverse, or cure Parkinson's disease—and outcomes vary.

Why size and visual targets?

Micrographia refers to abnormally small handwriting and may include a reduction in writing size as a person continues writing. Research has examined external visual targets and reminders to write with more normal amplitude.

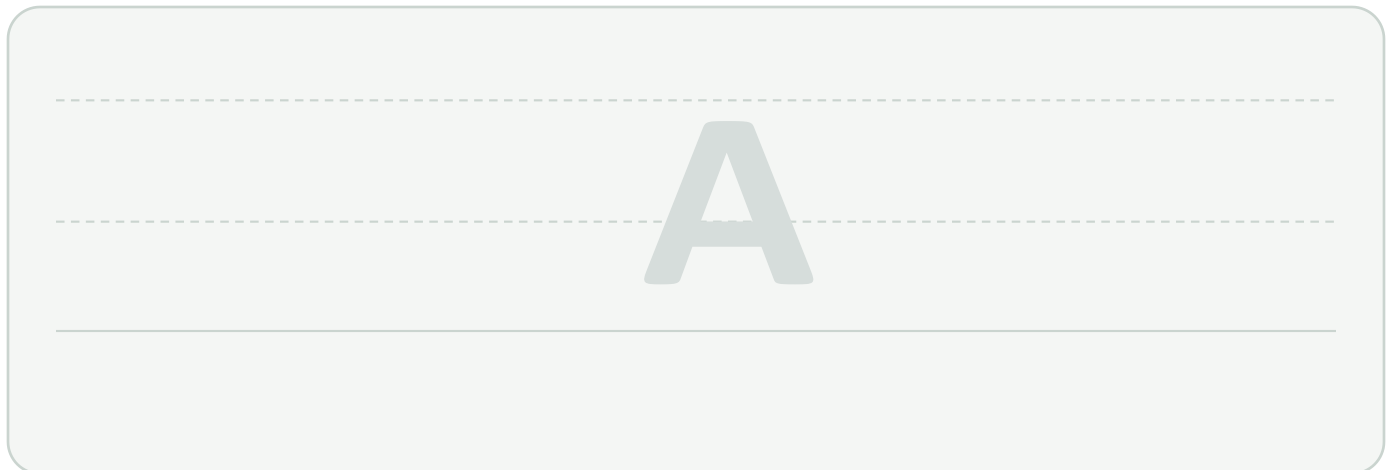
A SIMPLE VISUAL CUE



small

comfortable

large



Use the target area as a cue, not a medical protocol. The goal is a comfortable, intentional movement within the space provided.

Medical disclaimer

This workbook is an educational and practice resource. It is not medical advice, physical therapy, occupational therapy, diagnosis, or treatment for Parkinson's disease or any other condition.

The exercises and writing activities are general, evidence-informed practice ideas. Individual abilities, symptoms, medications, fatigue, balance, pain, tremor, rigidity, and other factors vary. What is appropriate for one person may not be appropriate for another.

IMPORTANT

This workbook does not promise to slow, stop, reverse, or cure Parkinson's disease, and completion of the workbook does not guarantee improved handwriting or motor function.

If you have questions about whether an activity is appropriate for you, discuss it with your physician, occupational therapist, physical therapist, or another qualified healthcare professional who knows your individual situation.

THE ENCOURAGING PART

Not making a medical promise does not make practice meaningless. Research supports handwriting-focused rehabilitation approaches, and this workbook gives you a practical place to engage in purposeful practice.

Practice with care

STOP FOR PAIN

If an exercise causes pain, stop that activity.

PAUSE FOR FATIGUE

Take a break if your hand or arm becomes tired. You do not need to finish a page in one sitting.

ADJUST THE CHALLENGE

Use a larger writing area, slow your pace, reduce repetitions, or return to an easier exercise when needed.

USE YOUR CARE TEAM

An occupational therapist or physical therapist can help individualize exercises, equipment, positioning, and goals.

WHY CAUTION MATTERS

The purpose of caution is not to make practice frightening. It is to help you practice thoughtfully.

Set up your practice space

Before you begin, make the page easy to use. A stable surface, comfortable seating, and a writing position that does not require strain can make practice feel more manageable.

01 Sit comfortably

Choose a chair and table height that lets your shoulders stay relaxed.

02 Place the page well

Move the page to a position that feels natural rather than twisting the wrist.

03 Choose your tool

Use the pen or pencil that feels easiest to control. A larger barrel may be comfortable for some people.

04 Support as needed

Let the forearm rest on the table if that feels steadier.

05 Keep it simple

A few focused minutes can be enough. You can always return later.

YOUR RULE

Use the setup that makes writing feel most stable and comfortable today. You do not need to copy someone else's grip or position.

Your 5-8 minute warm-up

Use this short routine before handwriting practice. Move comfortably and avoid forcing any motion.

01 OPEN Open your hands gently, then relax.

02 MOVE Wake up individual fingers.

03 TOUCH Practice thumb-to-fingertip coordination.

04 COORDINATE Use both hands together.

05 ROTATE Prepare the wrists and forearms.

06 RESET Relax before you pick up the pen.

REPEATABLE BY DESIGN

You can return to this page whenever you begin a practice session. The goal is not a long routine; it is a calm transition into purposeful movement.

Open & Release

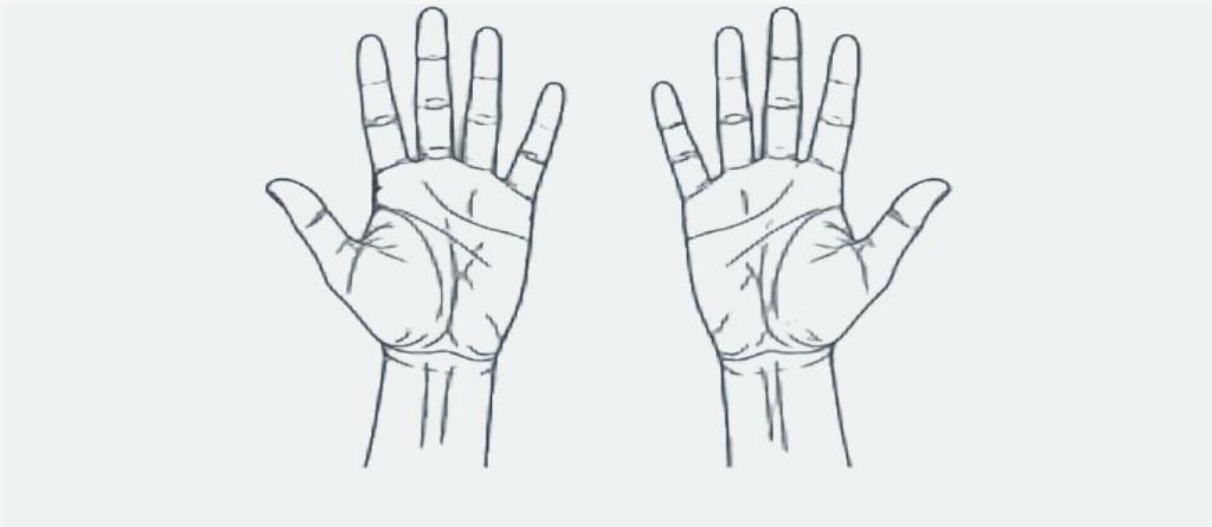
Open your fingers comfortably. Hold briefly, then relax. Repeat slowly with both hands.

PRACTICE CUE

Try 6-10 comfortable repetitions.

BOTH HANDS

SLOW • COMFORTABLE • CONTROLLED



Try 6-10 comfortable repetitions.

HOW DID IT FEEL TODAY?

☐ comfortable ☐ a little tiring ☐ difficult today

ONE-SENTENCE REMINDER

Try 6-10 comfortable repetitions.

Finger Isolation

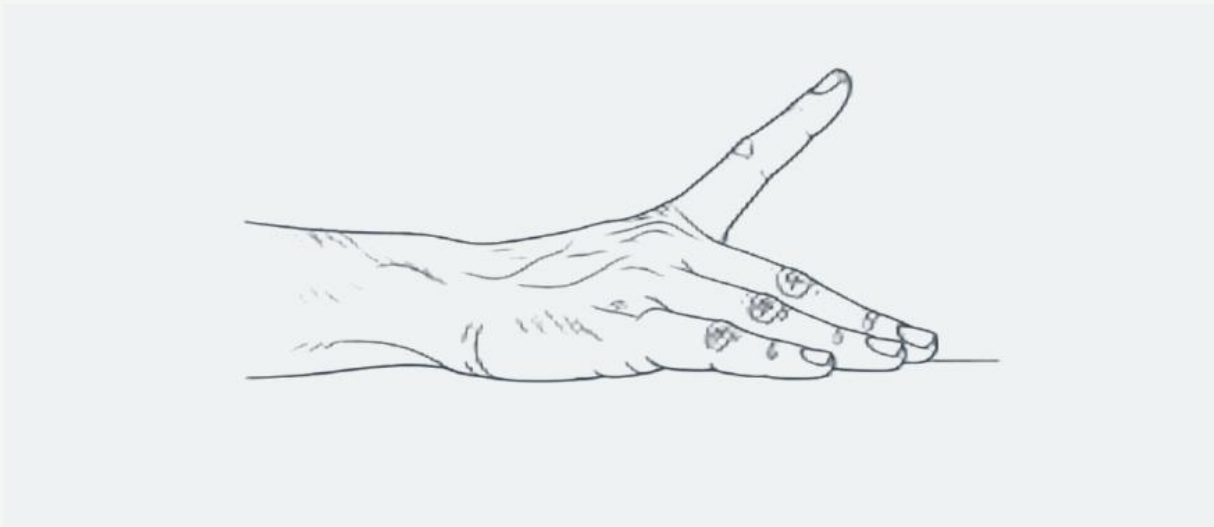
Rest the hand comfortably. Lift or move one finger at a time while allowing the other fingers to stay relaxed.

PRACTICE CUE

Move slowly. If a finger does not move independently, do not force it.

BOTH HANDS

SLOW • COMFORTABLE • CONTROLLED



Move slowly; do not force an isolated finger movement.

HOW DID IT FEEL TODAY?

☐ comfortable ☐ a little tiring ☐ difficult today

ONE-SENTENCE REMINDER

Move slowly. If a finger does not move independently, do not force it.

Thumb-to-Finger Coordination

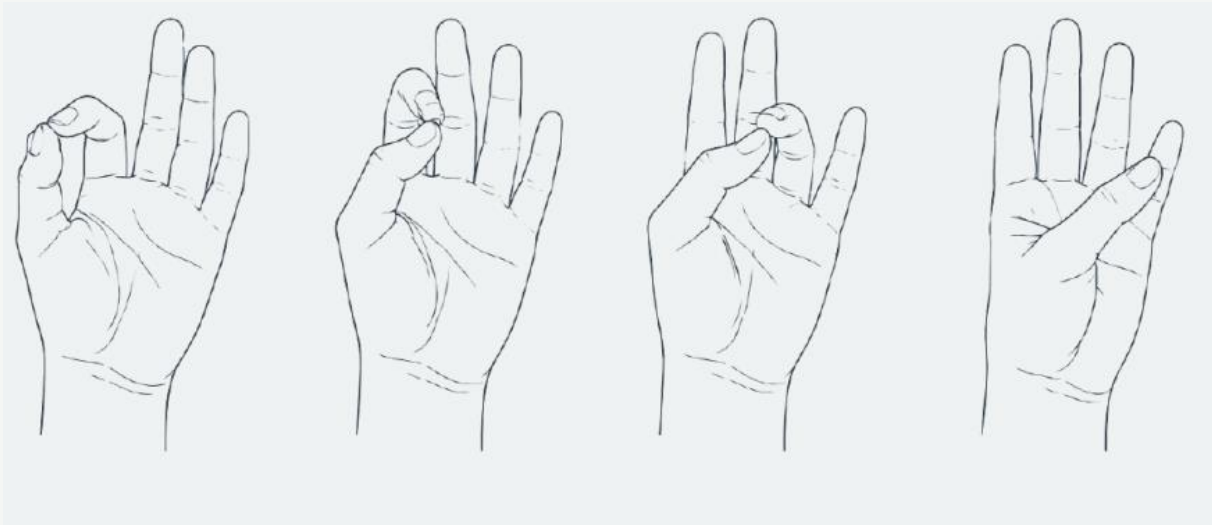
Touch the thumb to the index, middle, ring, and little finger in sequence. Repeat with the other hand.

PRACTICE CUE

Focus on deliberate contact rather than speed.

BOTH HANDS

SLOW • COMFORTABLE • CONTROLLED



Index -> middle -> ring -> little. Repeat.

HOW DID IT FEEL TODAY?

☐ comfortable ☐ a little tiring ☐ difficult today

ONE-SENTENCE REMINDER

Focus on deliberate contact rather than speed.

Both Hands Together

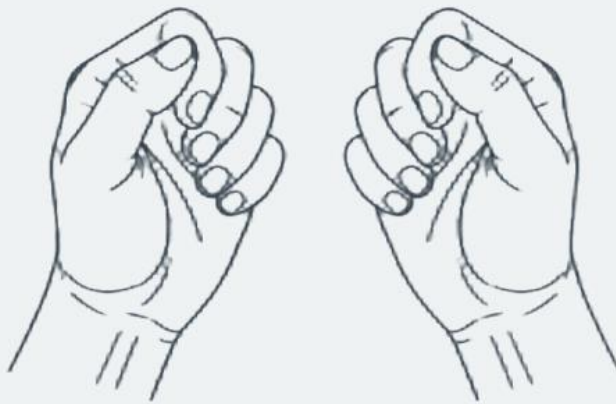
Open and close both hands together, then try matching simple finger patterns with both hands.

PRACTICE CUE

The purpose is coordination, not a race.

BOTH HANDS

SLOW • COMFORTABLE • CONTROLLED



Try matching the same shape on each side.

HOW DID IT FEEL TODAY?

☐ comfortable ☐ a little tiring ☐ difficult today

ONE-SENTENCE REMINDER

The purpose is coordination, not a race.

Wrist & Forearm Preparation

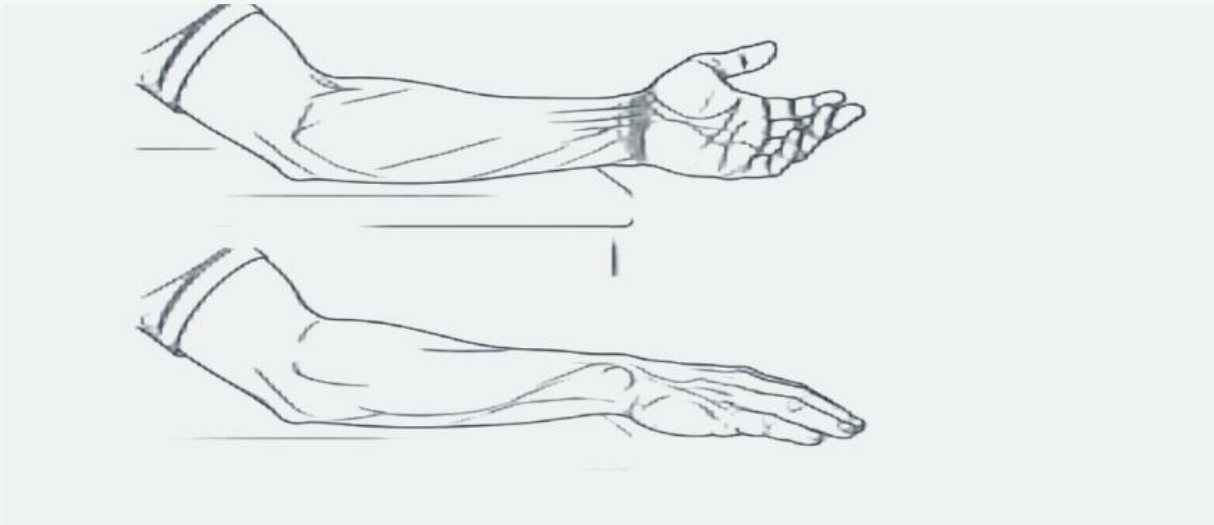
With the forearms supported comfortably, make gentle wrist movements and slow forearm rotations.

PRACTICE CUE

Keep the movement within a comfortable range.

BOTH HANDS

SLOW • COMFORTABLE • CONTROLLED



Move within a comfortable range—no forcing.

HOW DID IT FEEL TODAY?

☐ comfortable ☐ a little tiring ☐ difficult today

ONE-SENTENCE REMINDER

Keep the movement within a comfortable range.

Ready to Write

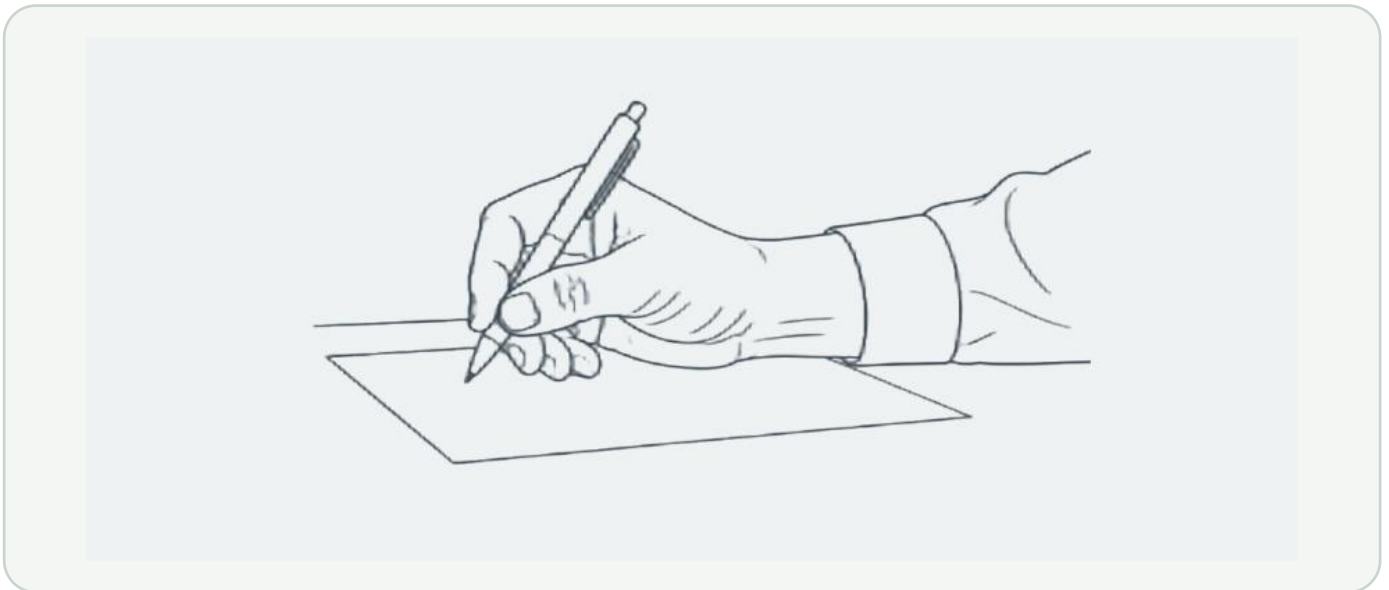
Relax the shoulders and hands. Place the paper where it feels comfortable. Hold your pen or pencil in your usual comfortable style.

PRACTICE CUE

You do not need to change your natural grip unless a qualified professional has recommended a change.

BOTH HANDS

SLOW • COMFORTABLE • CONTROLLED



Support the forearm if that feels steadier.

HOW DID IT FEEL TODAY?

☐ comfortable ☐ a little tiring ☐ difficult today

ONE-SENTENCE REMINDER

You do not need to change your natural grip unless a qualified professional has recommended a change.

Movement before letters

Lines, turns, curves, and larger movements give the hand a simple path before language adds complexity.

PREPARE

MOVE

WRITE

PRACTICE THAT FITS REAL LIFE

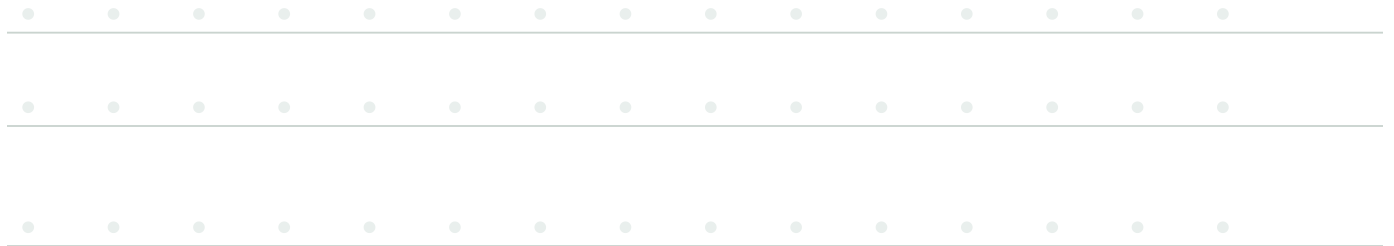
Each section builds a little more control while keeping the work useful, calm, and adult.

A NOTE BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Go at a comfortable pace. Use only as much of the page as feels manageable today. A smaller amount of good practice is still practice.

Straight Lines

Practice controlled horizontal and vertical lines. Keep the movement steady rather than fast.



LARGE PRACTICE AREA



MOVEMENT DEMONSTRATION



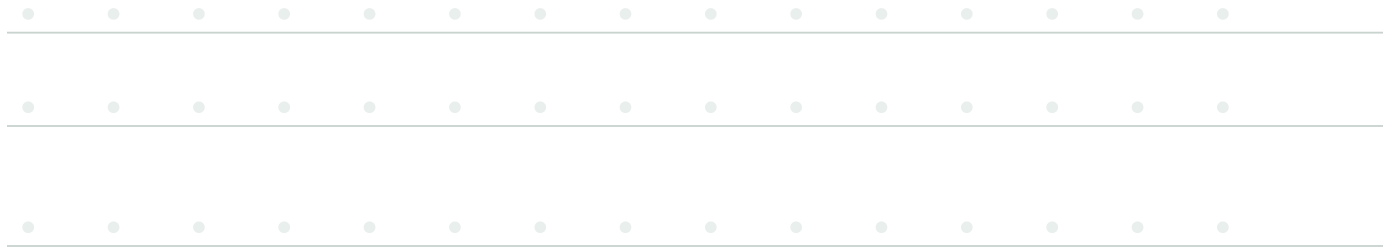
Start at the dot. Follow the line with an even, unhurried stroke.

WHAT TO NOTICE

Did the movement feel more controlled when you slowed down? Could you comfortably make the movement larger without straining?

Direction Changes

Move from one target point to another using horizontal, vertical, and diagonal paths.



LARGE PRACTICE AREA



MOVEMENT DEMONSTRATION



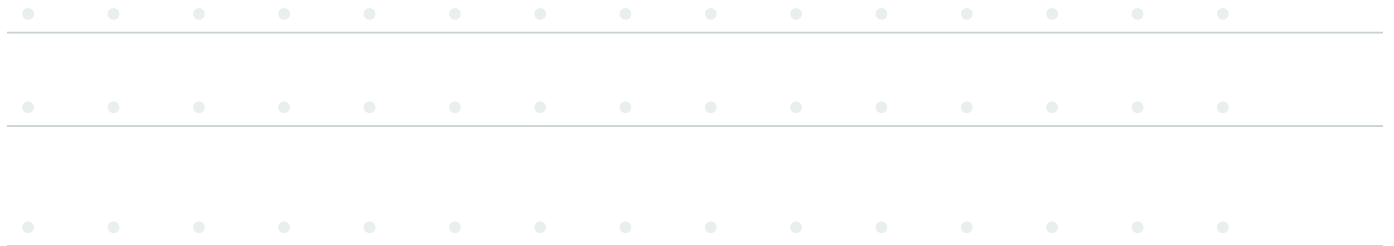
Change direction at each point without stopping the movement.

WHAT TO NOTICE

Did the movement feel more controlled when you slowed down? Could you comfortably make the movement larger without straining?

Curves

Practice smooth curves without worrying about making every curve identical.



LARGE PRACTICE AREA



MOVEMENT DEMONSTRATION



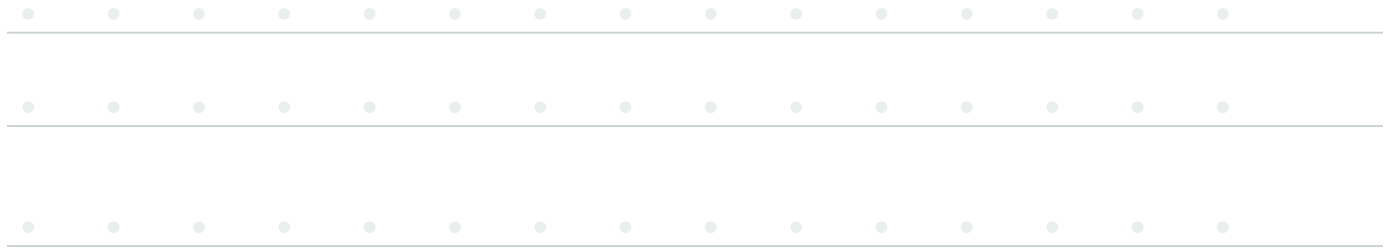
Let the curve stay smooth; the curves do not need to match.

WHAT TO NOTICE

Did the movement feel more controlled when you slowed down? Could you comfortably make the movement larger without straining?

Waves & Arches

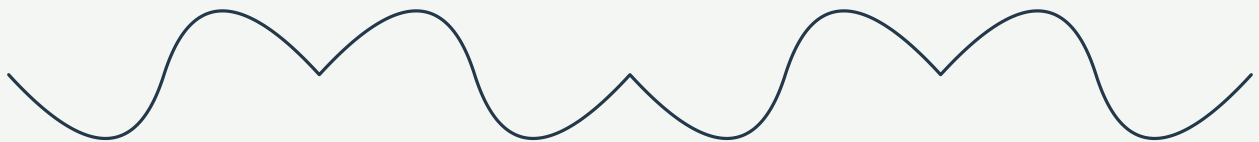
Make repeated waves and arches. Try to keep the pattern comfortably large.



LARGE PRACTICE AREA



MOVEMENT DEMONSTRATION



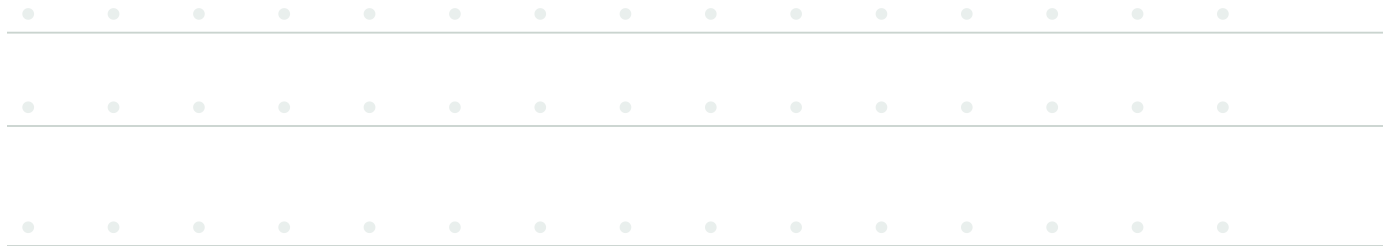
Keep the waves comfortably large and evenly spaced.

WHAT TO NOTICE

Did the movement feel more controlled when you slowed down? Could you comfortably make the movement larger without straining?

Circles & Loops

Practice circles and loops with enough space for the movement to feel deliberate.



LARGE PRACTICE AREA



MOVEMENT DEMONSTRATION



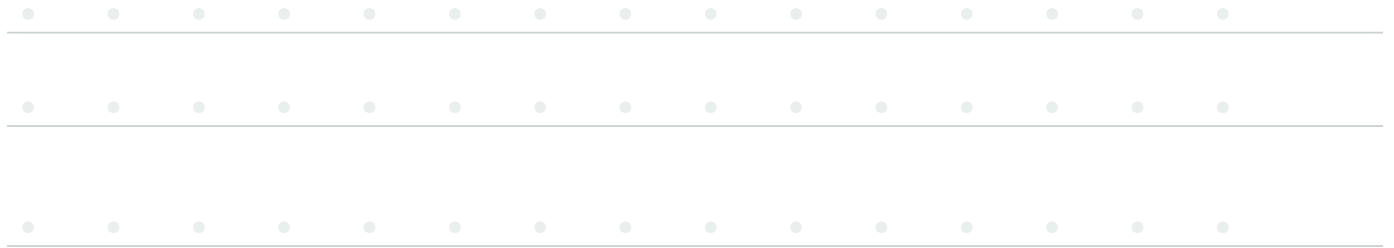
Give each loop enough room for the movement to feel deliberate.

WHAT TO NOTICE

Did the movement feel more controlled when you slowed down? Could you comfortably make the movement larger without straining?

Connected Patterns

Combine lines, curves, loops, and changes in direction.



LARGE PRACTICE AREA



MOVEMENT DEMONSTRATION



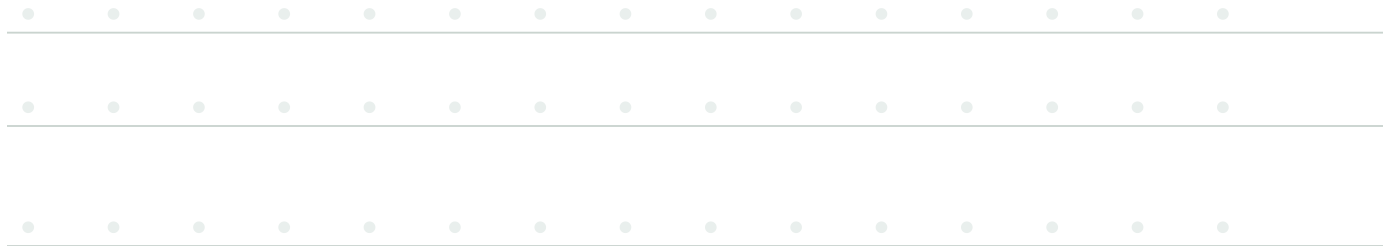
Combines lines, curves, and turns in one continuous movement.

WHAT TO NOTICE

Did the movement feel more controlled when you slowed down? Could you comfortably make the movement larger without straining?

Big Movement Challenge

Use the whole practice area. Make large, comfortable movements and notice whether your size stays consistent.



LARGE PRACTICE AREA



MOVEMENT DEMONSTRATION



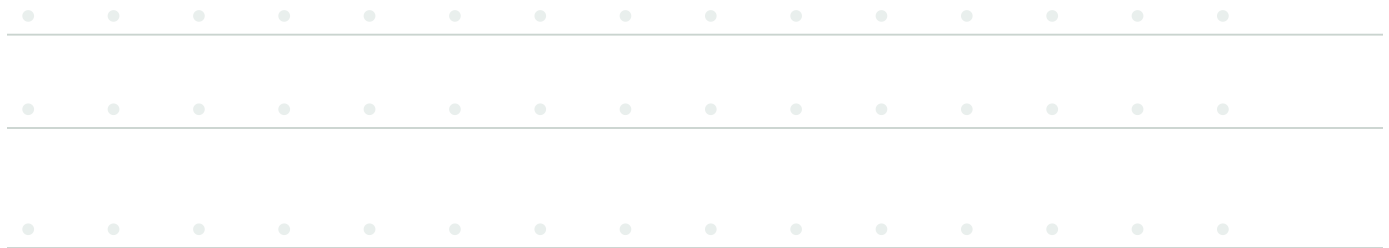
Use the full width of the page and keep the size comfortable from start to finish.

WHAT TO NOTICE

Did the movement feel more controlled when you slowed down? Could you comfortably make the movement larger without straining?

Movement Review

Choose two patterns that felt useful and repeat them slowly.



LARGE PRACTICE AREA



MOVEMENT DEMONSTRATION



Choose control over speed. Repeat what feels useful today.

WHAT TO NOTICE

Did the movement feel more controlled when you slowed down? Could you comfortably make the movement larger without straining?

Letters A-M

Start with the shape. Trace it. Write it independently. Then use the larger space to practice comfortable amplitude.

PREPARE

MOVE

WRITE

PRACTICE THAT FITS REAL LIFE

Each section builds a little more control while keeping the work useful, calm, and adult.

A NOTE BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Go at a comfortable pace. Use only as much of the page as feels manageable today. A smaller amount of good practice is still practice.

A in motion

A • a

See it. Trace it. Build it. Then write it in your own hand. Let the movement stay comfortable and deliberate.

01 • TRACE

A A A A

a a a a

02 • WRITE IT YOUR WAY

PAIR IT: Aa Aa Aa

03 • GO BIG

A

HOW DID IT FEEL TODAY?

☐ comfortable ☐ a little tiring ☐ difficult today

B in motion

B • b

See it. Trace it. Build it. Then write it in your own hand. Let the movement stay comfortable and deliberate.

01 • TRACE

B B B B

b b b b

02 • WRITE IT YOUR WAY

PAIR IT: Bb Bb Bb

03 • GO BIG

B

HOW DID IT FEEL TODAY?

☐ comfortable ☐ a little tiring ☐ difficult today

C in motion

C • c

See it. Trace it. Build it. Then write it in your own hand. Let the movement stay comfortable and deliberate.

01 • TRACE

C C C C

c c c c

02 • WRITE IT YOUR WAY

PAIR IT: Cc Cc Cc

03 • GO BIG

C

HOW DID IT FEEL TODAY?

☐ comfortable ☐ a little tiring ☐ difficult today

D in motion

D • d

See it. Trace it. Build it. Then write it in your own hand. Let the movement stay comfortable and deliberate.

01 • TRACE

D D D D

d d d d

02 • WRITE IT YOUR WAY

PAIR IT: Dd Dd Dd

03 • GO BIG

D

HOW DID IT FEEL TODAY?

☐ comfortable ☐ a little tiring ☐ difficult today

E in motion

E • e

See it. Trace it. Build it. Then write it in your own hand. Let the movement stay comfortable and deliberate.

01 • TRACE

E E E E

e e e e

02 • WRITE IT YOUR WAY

PAIR IT: Ee Ee Ee

03 • GO BIG

E

HOW DID IT FEEL TODAY?

☐ comfortable☐ a little tiring☐ difficult today

F in motion

F • f

See it. Trace it. Build it. Then write it in your own hand. Let the movement stay comfortable and deliberate.

01 • TRACE

F F F F**f f f f**

02 • WRITE IT YOUR WAY

PAIR IT: Ff Ff Ff

03 • GO BIG

F

HOW DID IT FEEL TODAY?

☐ comfortable ☐ a little tiring ☐ difficult today

G in motion

G • g

See it. Trace it. Build it. Then write it in your own hand. Let the movement stay comfortable and deliberate.

01 • TRACE

G G G G

g g g g

02 • WRITE IT YOUR WAY

PAIR IT: Gg Gg Gg

03 • GO BIG

G

HOW DID IT FEEL TODAY?

☐ comfortable ☐ a little tiring ☐ difficult today

H in motion

H • h

See it. Trace it. Build it. Then write it in your own hand. Let the movement stay comfortable and deliberate.

01 • TRACE

H H H H

h h h h

02 • WRITE IT YOUR WAY

PAIR IT: Hh Hh Hh

03 • GO BIG

H

HOW DID IT FEEL TODAY?

☐ comfortable ☐ a little tiring ☐ difficult today

STILL IN MOTION

I in motion

I • i

See it. Trace it. Build it. Then write it in your own hand. Let the movement stay comfortable and deliberate.

01 • TRACE

I I I I

i i i i

02 • WRITE IT YOUR WAY

PAIR IT: li li li

03 • GO BIG

HOW DID IT FEEL TODAY?

☐ comfortable ☐ a little tiring ☐ difficult today

J in motion

J • j

See it. Trace it. Build it. Then write it in your own hand. Let the movement stay comfortable and deliberate.

01 • TRACE

J J J J

j j j j

02 • WRITE IT YOUR WAY

PAIR IT: Jj Jj Jj

03 • GO BIG

J

HOW DID IT FEEL TODAY?

☐ comfortable ☐ a little tiring ☐ difficult today

K in motion

K • k

See it. Trace it. Build it. Then write it in your own hand. Let the movement stay comfortable and deliberate.

01 • TRACE

K K K K

k k k k

02 • WRITE IT YOUR WAY

PAIR IT: Kk Kk Kk

03 • GO BIG

A large uppercase letter 'K' is centered on a three-line grid. The top and bottom lines are solid, and the middle line is dashed. The letter 'K' is positioned between the top and bottom solid lines, with its base on the bottom solid line and its top reaching the top solid line. The letter is light gray and appears to be made of two parts: a vertical stem and a diagonal leg.

HOW DID IT FEEL TODAY?

- ☐ comfortable ☐ a little tiring ☐ difficult today

L in motion

L • |

See it. Trace it. Build it. Then write it in your own hand. Let the movement stay comfortable and deliberate.

01 • TRACE

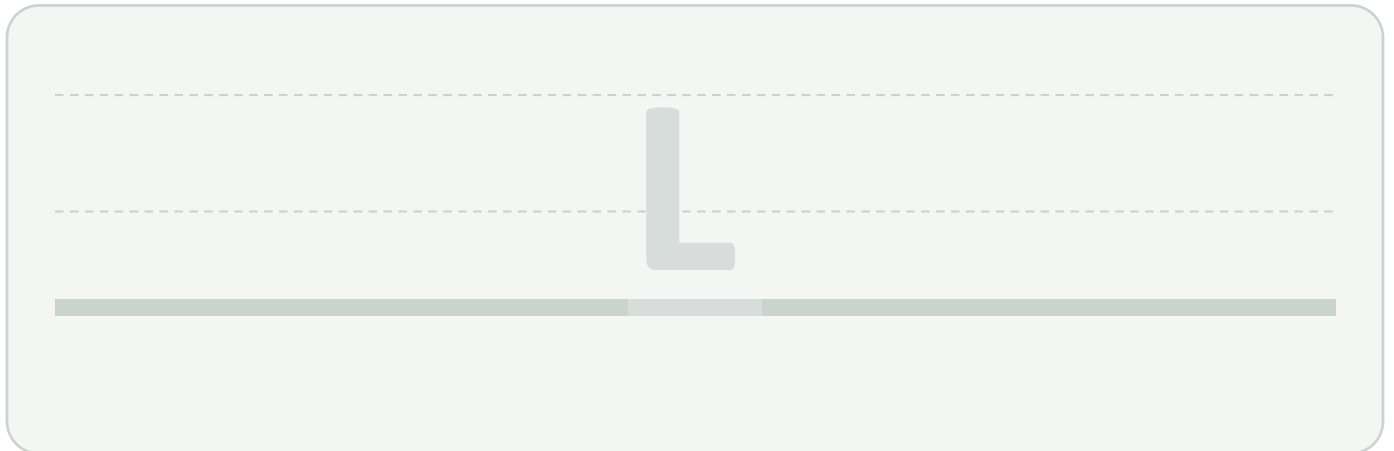
L L L L

| | | |

02 • WRITE IT YOUR WAY

PAIR IT: LI LI LI

03 • GO BIG



HOW DID IT FEEL TODAY?

☐ comfortable ☐ a little tiring ☐ difficult today

M in motion

M • m

See it. Trace it. Build it. Then write it in your own hand. Let the movement stay comfortable and deliberate.

01 • TRACE

M M M M

m m m m

02 • WRITE IT YOUR WAY

PAIR IT: Mm Mm Mm

03 • GO BIG

M

HOW DID IT FEEL TODAY?

☐ comfortable ☐ a little tiring ☐ difficult today

A-M review

Write through the letters you practiced. Use uppercase, lowercase, or both. Give each letter enough space to stay clear.

A a
_____**B b**
_____**C c**
_____**D d**
_____**E e**
_____**F f**
_____**G g**
_____**H h**
_____**I i**
_____**J j**
_____**K k**
_____**L l**
_____**M m**

WRITE ANY A-M LETTERS AGAIN

TIP

Choose the letters that feel easiest to recognize in your own handwriting and repeat those first.

Words that matter

Move from individual letters to familiar words, names, numbers, and short phrases that have a reason to be written.

PREPARE

MOVE

WRITE

PRACTICE THAT FITS REAL LIFE

Each section builds a little more control while keeping the work useful, calm, and adult.

A NOTE BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Go at a comfortable pace. Use only as much of the page as feels manageable today. A smaller amount of good practice is still practice.

Short, Familiar Words

Write each word once by tracing or copying, then write it again independently.

book

care

hand

help

kind

WRITE IT AGAIN IN YOUR OWN HANDWRITING

Everyday Words

Practice words you may see or use in ordinary life.

coffee

water

phone

paper

music

WRITE IT AGAIN IN YOUR OWN HANDWRITING

Names & Places

Names are personal and meaningful. Write slowly enough to make each letter clear.

Your name

A family name

Your town

Your favorite place

WRITE IT AGAIN IN YOUR OWN HANDWRITING

Numbers & Dates

Clear numbers are part of functional handwriting.

Phone number

Today's Date

Appointment time

ZIP code

WRITE IT AGAIN IN YOUR OWN HANDWRITING

Larger Words

Use the visual space. Try a large, comfortable version, then a more functional size.

Important

Remember

Appointment

Shopping

WRITE IT AGAIN IN YOUR OWN HANDWRITING

Spacing Practice

Write each phrase with clear space between words. Read it after writing.

I am ready.

Call me later.

See you soon.

Thank you.

WRITE IT AGAIN IN YOUR OWN HANDWRITING

Copy & Practice

Copy the examples below. Then try the same idea without looking.

Practice a little.

Take your time.

Keep your writing clear.

WRITE IT AGAIN IN YOUR OWN HANDWRITING

Your Own Words

Choose words that matter to you. They can be names, hobbies, places, foods, or everyday tasks.

Word 1:

Word 2:

Word 3:

WRITE IT AGAIN IN YOUR OWN HANDWRITING

Real-life writing

The most useful practice is often the kind that helps with ordinary tasks: lists, dates, notes, contacts, appointments, and messages.

PREPARE**MOVE****WRITE**

PRACTICE THAT FITS REAL LIFE

Each section builds a little more control while keeping the work useful, calm, and adult.

A NOTE BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Go at a comfortable pace. Use only as much of the page as feels manageable today. A smaller amount of good practice is still practice.

My Information

Practice the kinds of writing that helps you stay connected to everyday life.

Name

Address

Phone

Emergency contact

Numbers & Dates

Practice clear number writing for ordinary tasks.

Phone number

Date

Time

ZIP code

Other number

USE AS MUCH OR AS LITTLE SPACE AS YOU NEED

My Grocery List

Practice organizing a list while keeping each item easy to read.

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

USE AS MUCH OR AS LITTLE SPACE AS YOU NEED

My Household List

Write things to buy, things to do, or people to call.

Things to buy

Things to do

People to call

USE AS MUCH OR AS LITTLE SPACE AS YOU NEED

An Appointment

Practice the information you may need to write down or bring with you.

Date

Time

Location

What I want to remember

USE AS MUCH OR AS LITTLE SPACE AS YOU NEED

Dear

Message

From

62

63

My To-Do List

Choose a small number of tasks and give yourself generous writing space.

Today I want to:

1

2

3

4

USE AS MUCH OR AS LITTLE SPACE AS YOU NEED

Free Functional Writing

Write anything useful to you today: a note, reminder, short story, address, list, or message.

Write anything useful to you today.

USE AS MUCH OR AS LITTLE SPACE AS YOU NEED

Your daily 10-minute practice

The 10-minute structure below is a simple adherence framework created for this workbook. It is not a medically prescribed dose of exercise. Adjust it to your abilities and healthcare guidance.

2 MIN**HAND WARM-UP**

Choose one or two preparation pages.

2 MIN**MOVEMENT**

Choose lines, turns, curves, or large movement.

4 MIN**HANDWRITING**

Practice one letter page or a words page.

2 MIN**FUNCTIONAL WRITING**

Write one real-life task: list, number, note, or appointment.

KEEP IT REAL

A short routine you can repeat is more useful than an elaborate routine you rarely use.

Practice tracker

Use one row per practice session. Keep the record simple enough that it does not become another task to manage.

DATE	WARM-UP	HANDWRITING	FEELING	NOTES
	☐ yes ☐ no	☐ yes ☐ no	☐ comfortable ☐ tiring	
	☐ yes ☐ no	☐ yes ☐ no	☐ comfortable ☐ tiring	
	☐ yes ☐ no	☐ yes ☐ no	☐ comfortable ☐ tiring	
	☐ yes ☐ no	☐ yes ☐ no	☐ comfortable ☐ tiring	
	☐ yes ☐ no	☐ yes ☐ no	☐ comfortable ☐ tiring	
	☐ yes ☐ no	☐ yes ☐ no	☐ comfortable ☐ tiring	
	☐ yes ☐ no	☐ yes ☐ no	☐ comfortable ☐ tiring	

REMEMBER

A blank day does not erase your work. Start again on the next page.

Choose your practice

Today I want to practice:

☐ **A-M letters**

☐ **Big movement**

☐ **Words**

☐ **Numbers & dates**

☐ **Functional
writing**

☐ **A page I have not tried**

☐ **A page I want to repeat**

A GOOD CHOICE

Choose one thing that feels useful today. You do not need to finish everything.

WHY THIS PAGE?

Repeat & strengthen

Return to one exercise that deserves another try. Repetition can make a useful page easier to revisit.

WHAT WILL I REPEAT?

Write the name or number of the page you want to revisit.

WHY?

What felt useful about this activity?

MAKE IT EASIER

When a page feels difficult, shrink the task rather than abandoning practice: fewer repetitions, larger space, slower pace, or a shorter session.

My progress

Notice what is useful without turning the workbook into a scorecard.

Something that felt comfortable:

Something I want to practice again:

A daily task I want to keep writing:

A QUIET WIN

Being able to say "this feels more manageable today" counts as useful information.

Keep going

The goal is not to prove that everything is easy. It is to keep creating opportunities to participate in everyday life.

PREPARE

MOVE

WRITE

PRACTICE THAT FITS REAL LIFE

Each section builds a little more control while keeping the work useful, calm, and adult.

A NOTE BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Go at a comfortable pace. Use only as much of the page as feels manageable today. A smaller amount of good practice is still practice.

A-M review

Write through the alphabet you practiced. Use uppercase, lowercase, or both. Give each letter enough room to stay clear.

A

B

C

D

E

F

G

H

I

J

K

L

M

Big writing review

Use the space to make several large, comfortable letters and movements. The goal is size that remains controlled and readable.

A large, light gray letter 'A' is centered on a set of three horizontal dashed lines. Below the dashed lines is a solid horizontal line. The entire box has rounded corners.

A

A large, light gray letter 'M' is centered on a set of three horizontal dashed lines. Below the dashed lines is a solid horizontal line. The entire box has rounded corners.

M

A large, light gray letter 'a' is centered on a set of three horizontal dashed lines. Below the dashed lines is a solid horizontal line. The entire box has rounded corners.

a

BIG • COMFORTABLE • CONTROLLED

Functional writing review

Practice one list, one phone number, and one short note. Keep the tasks realistic and familiar.

LIST

Three things to buy

NUMBER

A phone number or ZIP code

NOTE

A short message to someone

My favorite exercises

Which warm-up, movement, letter, word, or functional writing page felt most useful to you?

FAVORITE 1

Why was it useful?

FAVORITE 2

Why was it useful?

FAVORITE 3

Why was it useful?

My practice plan

Choose a realistic routine you can return to. Keep it simple enough to use in real life.

How often?

When will I practice?

Which pages will I use?

What will I do when I am tired?

What will help me keep going?

Keep going

The purpose of practice is not to prove that everything is easy. It is to keep giving yourself opportunities to participate in the life around you.

A FINAL REMINDER

You do not have to do everything today. Choose one useful movement, one useful page, and one useful task - and begin there.

EVIDENCE & FURTHER READING

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|---|
| Foster ER, et al. | Occupational Therapy Interventions for Instrumental Activities of Daily Living for Adults With Parkinson's Disease: A Systematic Review. American Journal of Occupational Therapy. 2021. PMID 34781350. |
| Vorasoot N, et al. | Effects of handwriting exercise on functional outcome in Parkinson's disease: A randomized controlled trial. Journal of Clinical Neuroscience. 2020. PMID 31506240. |
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| Orci K, et al. | Effects of Upper Limb Exercise or Training on Hand Dexterity and Function in People With Parkinson's Disease: A Systematic Review and Meta-analysis. 2023. PMID 38042246. |

Research statements in this workbook are presented as context and do not replace individualized medical or rehabilitation guidance.